

Decline of the Bahmani Kingdom

After the death of Sultan Mohammed III five of his descendants succeeded him on the throne but they were kings only in name. During this period the Sultanate gradually broke up into four independent kingdoms: Bijapur, Ahmadnagar, Berar and Golkonda. Bidar where the Bahmani Sultan ruled as a puppet became the fifth one. Among these Bijapur became powerful by annexing Bidar and Berar in course of time. Though Ahmadnagar and Golkonda acted independently they finally joined with Bijapur to fight with their common enemy, Vijayanagar. Vijayanagar was utterly routed in the battle of Talikota or *Rakshashi-Tangadi* in 1565. Thereafter, within a century, the Sultanates were vanquished one after another and taken over by the Mughal state.

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